OTT

The Fire WITHIN

A versatile actor, **Divyenndu** *finally gets to play a law enforcement officer in Amazon Prime's* Agni



ON COP DUTY
Divyenndu in *Agni*

IN a career spanning nearly 15 years, Divyenndu has played a lovesick fool, a gangster, a robber, a buddy with trouble in his DNA, but, surprisingly, never a cop. Long seen as an actor with a funny bone who manages to crack up audiences–as he did earlier this year in *Madgaon Express*–he hopes to go beyond the label with the Amazon Prime feature *Agni*. Here he gets to both flex his dramatic chops and essay an encounter specialist.

"Comedy is not my comfort zone, it takes a lot of effort," says Divyenndu, who is best known for playing two iconic characters–Liquid in *Pyaar Ka Punchnama* and Munna in the *Mirzapur* series. "Many think that comedy can be done through performance when, in fact, it has to be written intelligently first. I don't enjoy comedy where you start laughing before the punch line or joke. I like sarcasm more,

CINEMA

IT'S STORY TIME

Filmmaker **Suruchi Sharma**, known for her deep-dive documentaries on folk culture, returns to fiction



ROOTED TALE A still from *Gagan Gaman*, which is written, directed and co-produced by Suruchi Sharma (right)

Over the past decade, 34-year-old Suruchi Sharma has been nestled deep into the world of Indian folk culture. In 2016, she directed, shot, and edited *Utsav*, her first short, an observational piece that laid bare the significance of folk entertainment in a Rajasthan village. A year later, the National Institute of Design alumna made *Of Love and Artistry*, a documentary that spotlighted the life stories of folk artists from Rajasthan. Then, in 2020, she helmed *Meen Raag*, a masterful documentation of the varying musical traditions that abound in the tribal Meena community, which earned her a National Award for Best Location Sound. And, last year, Sharma directed *Equals*, a seven-episode documentary series that profiled the lives and music of legendary folk musicians across the country.

In a sense, meeting folk artists and contending with their artistry while filming around the